



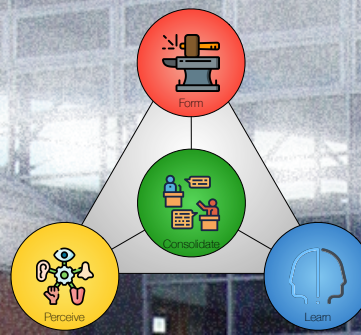
AALBORG UNIVERSITY
DENMARK

12 RESEARCH PAPER & COURSE OVERVIEW

HEVNER, A. & GREGOR, S. (2022). ENVISIONING
ENTREPRENEURSHIP AND DIGITAL INNOVATION THROUGH A
DESIGN SCIENCE RESEARCH LENS: A MATRIX APPROACH.
INFORMATION & MANAGEMENT, 59(3), 103350.

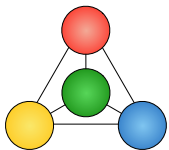
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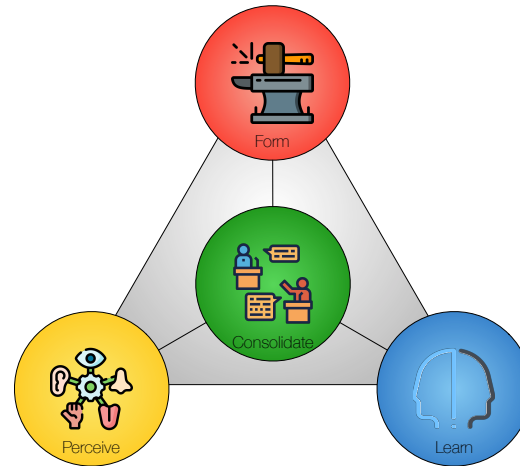
SWI 2026



Agenda

- Exercise I I Follow-up.
- Research Paper:
Envisioning entrepreneurship and digital innovation through a design science research lens: A matrix approach.
- Course Overview (Separate file).



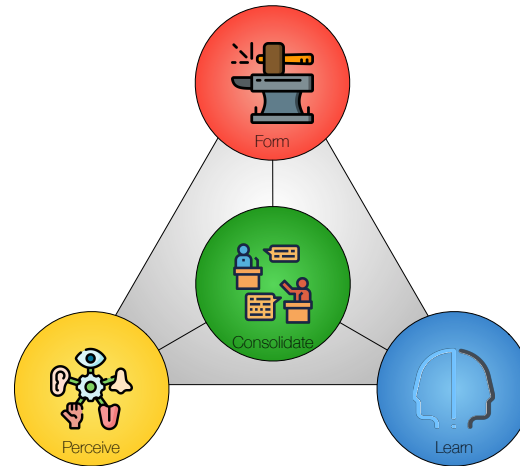


Follow-up: Exercise I I

Exercise 11 (Merit)

This exercise concerns **functional** and **non-functional** requirements, as well as strategies for improving **robustness** and managing **dependencies**.

- Discuss the **functional** completeness of your design and state *reservations*, *rebuttals*, and *values* accordingly.
- Discuss the **robustness** of your design and assess if any of the strategies in section 18.2 would be helpful.
- Outline **dependencies** in your design and assess the utility of the strategies in section 18.3.
- Use **ETVX** (section 18.4) to model **robustness** and **dependencies**.



Research Paper

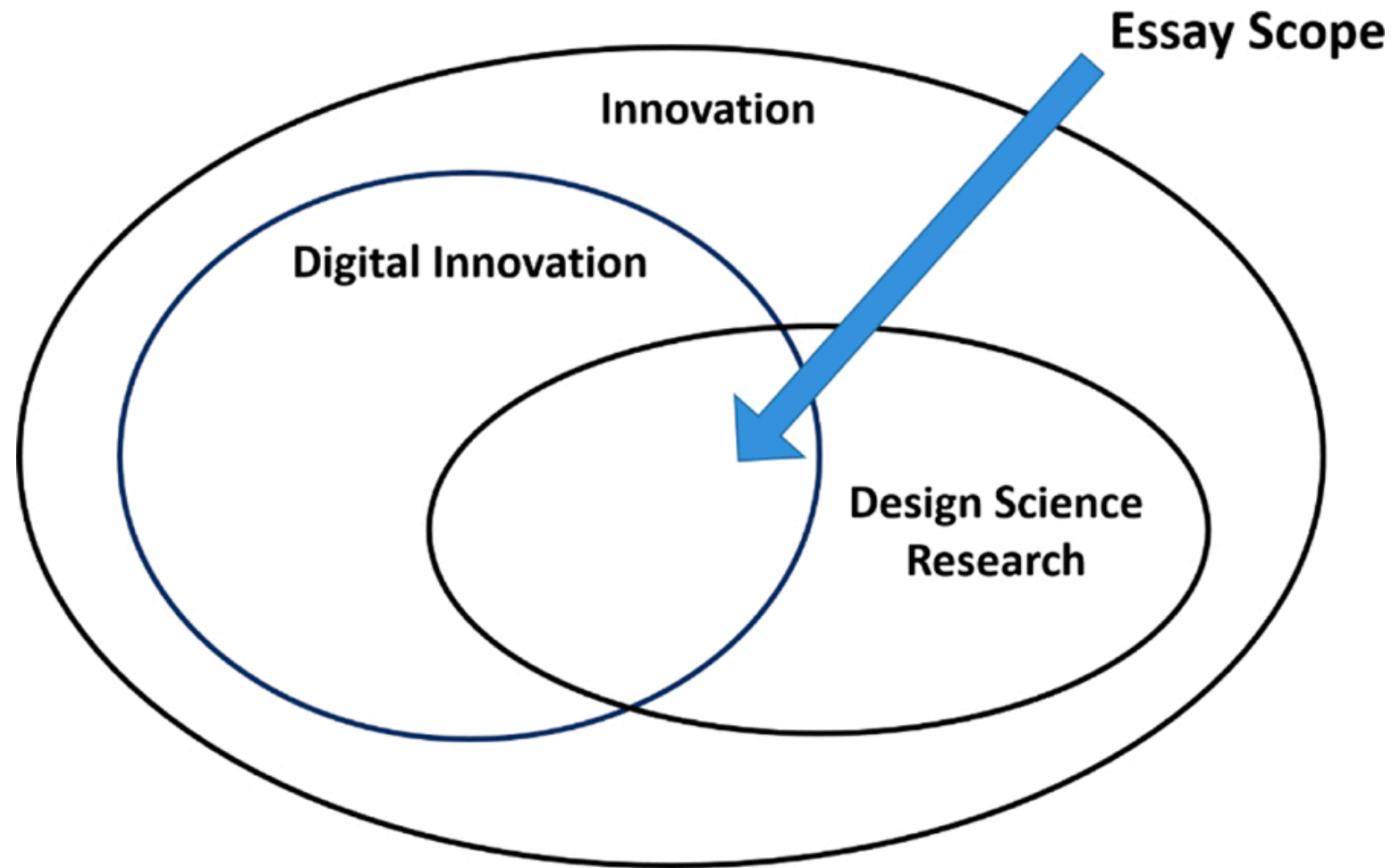
Why they wrote the essay

- *Design Science Research (DSR) in the information systems (IS) field is, at its essence, about Digital Innovation (DI).*
- *Innovative sociotechnical design artifacts involve digital information technologies (IT) being used in ways that result in profound disruptions to traditional ways of doing business and to widespread societal changes.*
- *In this paper we present a new matrix approach to DI based on DSR, entrepreneurship, and innovation theories.*
- *We define the combined DSR and DI matrix approach in terms of four strategies: invention; advancement; exaptation; and exploitation and their associated DI practices.*

Main Concepts

- *Digital Innovation*: The appropriation of digital technologies in the process of and as the result of innovation. Digital innovation emphasizes combinations of digital and physical components to produce novel products.
- *Design Science Research*: DSR in the study of sociotechnical information systems creates and evaluates IT artifacts to solve organizational problems via a rigorous research focus that requires the contribution of new, transferable knowledge not known to previously exist.

Scope of Essay – Digital Innovation and Design Science Research



Main Approach: Effectuation

- *Effectuation processes* take a set of *means* as given and focus on selecting between possible *effects* that can be created with that set of means. *Causation processes* take a particular *effect* as given and focus on selecting between *means* to create that effect.
- Effectuation logic has some commonality with the idea of “*need-solution*” *pairs* advanced by von Hippel and von Krogh, who argue that problem formulation need not precede problem solving, but rather *a need* and *a solution* may be *discovered* together.

Distinguishing Characteristic

The distinguishing characteristic between causation and effectuation is in the set of choices:

- *Choosing between*
 - *means to create a particular effect (causation),*
 - *many possible effects using a particular set of means (effectuation)*
- *Causation models consist of many-to-one mappings*
- *Effectuation models involve one-to-many mappings*

The Problem Space for Effectuation

Where do we find *rationality* when

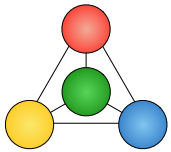
- the *environment* does not independently influence outcomes or even rules of the game (Weick, 1979),
- the future is truly *unpredictable* (Knight, 1921), and
- the decision maker is *unsure* of his/her own preferences (March, 1982)?

	Existing Market	New Market
Existing Product		
New product		Suicide Quadrant

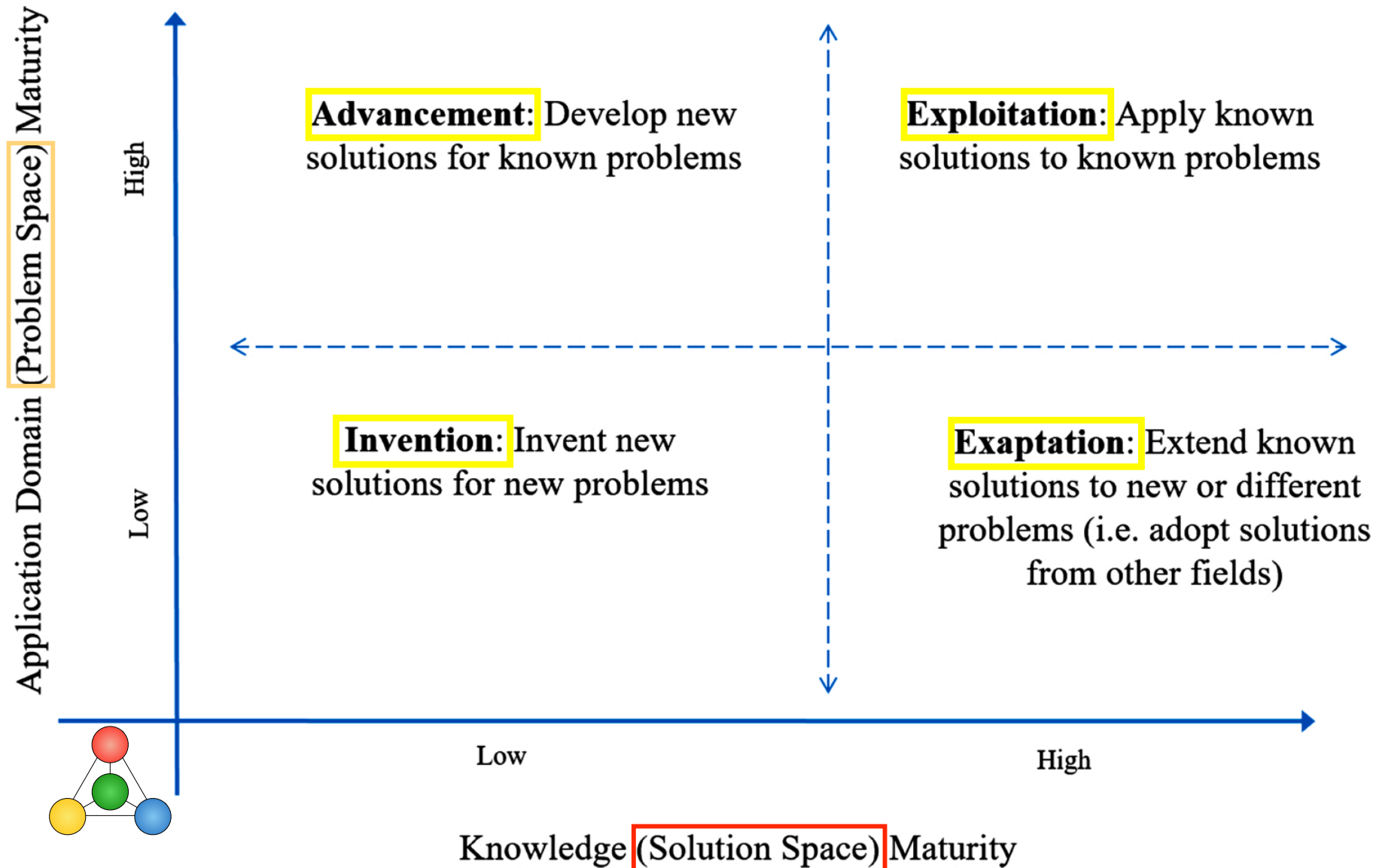
Knowledge Innovation

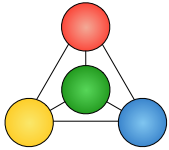
Maturity Dimensions

- The *application domain* (**problem**) maturity dimension, which resonates with the key roles in innovation of opportunities, tasks and problems, markets, needs and fields.
- The *knowledge* (**solution**) maturity dimension, which resonates with the key roles in innovation of new ideas, new insights, new knowledge and skills, technological know-how, new knowledge, and learning.

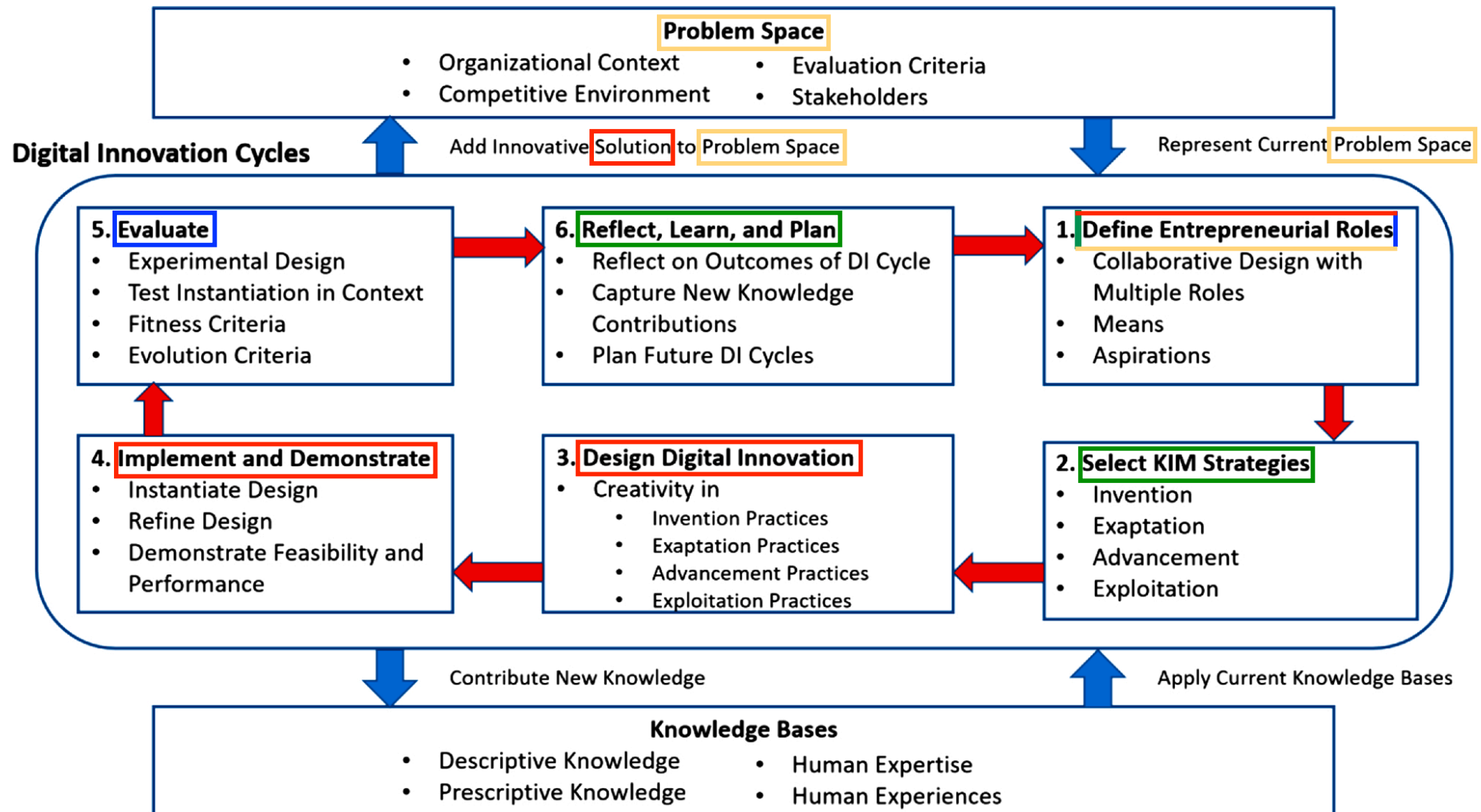


KIM: Knowledge Innovation Matrix





Process model with strategies and roles



Discussion of the paper

- Focus on **processes** (rather than **structures**).
- Focus on **strategy** (as opposed to **rationale** or **tactics**).
- **Catalog of strategies** (as opposed to **tools** and **techniques**).
- **Integrates** innovation and entrepreneurship (as opposed to keeping them **separate**)
- Views **invention** as one form of **innovation** (as opposed to viewing innovation as the **combination** of invention, exploitation, and diffusion).
- Main focus on **management** (rather than **development**).
- Tends to favor **effectuation** with a hint of **causation**.